Racial Equity and Social Justice Lens



(Updated December 2018)
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Introduction ›

PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

PPS Racial Equity and Social Justice Lens

Updated April 2021

Portland Public Schools is committed to academic excellence and personal success for all students. Central to this commitment is the support of racial equity and social justice. Dedicated policy, people, and practice are necessary to create a culturally responsive organization that ensures the success of students who can navigate and compete in a culturally complex society and global economy. It is through racial equity and social justice that PPS will become a premier school district.

In May 2019, PPS adopted our community-informed Vision, Portland Public Schools is committed to preparing our students to lead change and improve the world for the district we aim to become by 2030. Our community defined our:

- **Vision:** A picture of what we want for our students. The Vision includes the Graduate Portrait, Educator Essentials, Educational System Shifts, and Core Values.
- **Core Values:** The district's enduring beliefs that will guide our action toward our collective Vision.
- **Graduate Portrait:** A clear and ambitious description of what the community wants our students to know, be, and be able to do, in order to prepare them to thrive in their lives and careers.
- **Educator Essentials:** The knowledge, skills, mindsets, and dispositions needed from adults to support the Graduate Portrait.
- **System Shifts:** Changes to the district's priorities and operations that will help create the conditions required to reach our Vision.



With a community-informed Vision established, we are developing a multi-year **strategic plan** that guides our decisions and investments to realize the Vision for our graduates and the larger learning ecosystem.

In order to advance toward the Vision and achieve the 3-year Board Goals, PPS examined its current state to develop a **theory of action** for change to identify key priorities.

We utilize this theory of action to provide focus and to center our decision making on the experiences of students of color. Our Theory of Action explicitly calls out the pernicious institutional and cultural racism embedded in our system and prompts us to take action that disrupts the barriers that hinder us from reaching our goals.

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Racial Equity and Social Justice Lens Protocols
2021-22

Who will use the Racial Equity and Social Justice (RESJ) Lens?
The goal is for everyone at Portland Public Schools to regularly apply the updated RESJ Lens. All employees will continue to practice utilizing the critical thinking and evaluation skills developed while using the lens as part of PPS's commitment to racial equity and social justice. We believe this practice will continue to inform our organizational development and strengthen our collective impact. The result of creating an organizational culture where the RESJ lens is regularly utilized and the results are analyzed will focus everyone on achieving measurable outcomes addressing our internal barriers and practices.

When will the RESJ Lens be applied?
To effectively roll out the use of PPS's updated RESJ Lens all departments will identify scenarios for use in the 2021-22 school year. It is expected that departments will complete the RESJ lens for at least the identified scenarios, however, it is likely that departments will also find it useful for additional scenarios.

PPS Department	Scenarios	Estimated Month Completed
Superintendent's Leadership Team	• 2022-23 SY Budget • Strategic Plan Adoption	May 2022 August 2021
Human Resources	• Reimagine Wellness Plan and Framework • Reclassification or internal promotion versus external posting of positions	June 2022 Dec 2021
Finance	• Develop a Year Round BIPOC Community Centered Engagement to Budgeting Framework that uses the RESJ Lens. • Align Budget Planning to support Strategic initiatives/goals that can measurably improve Black and Native Student Academic Outcomes	Sept-2021 June-2022
Custodial/ Maintenance	• Facility Maintenance Plan • Determining APPA Cleaning Standard level for each school • Diverse recruitment strategies for filling additional 30 FTE for Custodial	June 2022 June 2022 June 2022

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